
Pakistan studies



Chapter 2



In the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Most Kind

Political History Of Pakistan

The early years (1947-58)

- Pakistan was striated in hopeless urgency. It came into existence with horrible loss of life and property, and the migration of millions of dazed.



• Prime Ministers of Pakistan (1947 – 1958)

- Early Pakistan (1947–1958) – Post-Independence Era
- ① Liaquat Ali Khan
 - 15 August 1947 – 16 October 1951
(First Prime Minister of Pakistan)
- ② Khawaja Nazimuddin
 - 17 October 1951 – 17 April 1953
- ③ Muhammad Ali Bogra
 - 17 April 1953 – 12 August 1955
- ④ Chaudhry Muhammad Ali
 - 12 August 1955 – 12 September 1956

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- **5 Hussain Shaheed Suhrawardy**
 - **12 September 1956 – 17 October 1957**
 - **6 Ibrahim Ismail Chundrigar**
 - **17 October 1957 – 16 December 1957**
 - **7 Malik Feroz Khan Noon**
 - **16 December 1957 – 7 October 1958**

Martial Laws in Pakistan

- **① Ayub Khan**
7 October 1958 – 25 March 1969
- **② Yahya Khan**
25 March 1969 – 20 December 1971
- **③ Zia-ul-Haq**
5 July 1977 – 17 August 1988
- **④ Pervez Musharraf**
12 October 1999 – 18 August 2008

- **Military & Democratic Transition (1999–2002)**

- **① Mir Zafarullah Khan Jamali**

23 November 2002 – 26 June 2004

- **② Chaudhry Shujaat Hussain (Caretaker)**

30 June 2004 – 23 August 2004

- **③ Shaukat Aziz**

28 August 2004 – 15 November 2007

Modern Democratic Era (2008–Present)

- **4 Yousaf Raza Gillani**
25 March 2008 – 19 June 2012
- **5 Raja Pervez Ashraf**
22 June 2012 – 24 March 2013
- **6 Nawaz Sharif (3rd Term)**
5 June 2013 – 28 July 2017
- **7 Shahid Khaqan Abbasi**
1 August 2017 – 31 May 2018
- **8 Imran Khan**
18 August 2018 – 10 April 2022

Governor Generals(1947 – 1956)

- **Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah** – 15 Aug 1947 – 11 Sept 1948 (Governor-General)
- **Khawaja Nazimuddin** – 14 Sept 1948 – 17 Apr 1953 (Governor-General)
- **Ghulam Muhammad** – 17 Apr 1953 – 6 Oct 1955 (Governor-General)
- **Iskander Mirza** – 6 Oct 1955 – 23 Mar 1956 (Governor-General)

PRESIDENTS AFTER 1956

1 **Iskander Mirza**

23 March 1956 – 27 October 1958

2 **Ayub Khan**

27 October 1958 – 25 March 1969

3 **Yahya Khan**

25 March 1969 – 20 December 1971

4 **Zulfikar Ali Bhutto**

20 December 1971 – 13 August 1973

5 **Fazal Ilahi Chaudhry**

14 August 1973 – 16 September 1978

6 **Muhammad Zia-ul-Haq**

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- **7 Ghulam Ishaq Khan**
17 August 1988 – 18 July 1993
 - **8 Farooq Leghari**
14 November 1993 – 2 December 1997
 - **9 Muhammad Rafiq Tarar**
1 January 1998 – 20 June 2001
 - **10 Pervez Musharraf**
20 June 2001 – 18 August 2008
 - **11 Asif Ali Zardari**
9 September 2008 – 8 September 2013
 - **12 Mamnoon Hussain**
9 September 2013 – 9 September 2018

- **13 Arif Alvi**

9 September 2018 – 10 March 2024

- **14 Asif Ali Zardari**

10 March 2024 – Present

The first prime minister



Liaquat Ali Khan (1895–1951)

Liaquat Ali Khan was the **first Prime Minister of Pakistan** and one of the closest companions of **Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah**.

Birth: 1 October 1895, Karnal (British India)

Death: 16 October 1951, Rawalpindi (assassinated)

Political Party: All-India Muslim League

Office Held:

- **First Prime Minister of Pakistan (1947–1951)**
- **First Finance Minister of Pakistan**

- **Key Contributions & Importance**

- Played a **vital role in the Pakistan Movement** and supported Quaid-e-Azam at every stage.
- Presented Pakistan's **first budget** in 1947.
- Introduced the **Objectives Resolution (1949)**, which laid the **ideological foundation of Pakistan's constitution**.
- Strengthened Pakistan's position internationally during early years.
- Visited the **United States in 1950**, shaping Pakistan's early foreign policy.

- **Objectives Resolution (1949) – MOST IMPORTANT**

- Declared that **sovereignty belongs to Allah**.
- Provided a framework for **Islamic democracy** in Pakistan.
- Became the **preamble of the 1956, 1962, and 1973 Constitutions**.

Jinnah and Mount batten talks

The **Jinnah–Mountbatten talks** started in March **1947**, soon after **Lord Mountbatten** assumed office as the last **Viceroy of India** on **24 March 1947**, and ended on **3 June 1947** with the announcement of the **June 3 Partition Plan**.

During this period, several meetings were held to discuss the **transfer of power and partition**, in which **Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah** firmly insisted on a **separate and sovereign Pakistan**, leading ultimately to the decision to divide British India and create **Pakistan** on **14 August 1947**.



Kashmir crisis

The **Kashmir issue** is a major dispute between **Pakistan** and **India** since **1947**. Jammu and Kashmir was a **Muslim-majority princely state** ruled by **Maharaja Hari Singh**, who later signed the **Instrument of Accession** with India, a decision **rejected by Pakistan**. This caused the **first Indo-Pak war (1947–48)** and brought the issue to the **United Nations**, which promised a **plebiscite** that has **not been held**. Kashmir is now divided by the **Line of Control (LoC)**, with **Pakistan administering Azad Kashmir and Gilgit-Baltistan**, and **India controlling Jammu, Kashmir Valley, and Ladakh**. Due to its **strategic location, water resources, and political importance**, Kashmir remains a **core issue in Pakistan-India relations** and a source of regional tension.



Death of Quaid e Azam

Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the Founder of Pakistan, **died on 11 September 1948** in **Karachi** after a prolonged illness. He had been suffering from **tuberculosis and lung disease**, which worsened due to extreme workload and stress after the creation of Pakistan. His death occurred barely **one year after independence**, at a time when the new state was facing serious political and administrative challenges. Quaid-e-Azam's death was a **great national loss**, as Pakistan was deprived of its most visionary, honest, and unifying leader at a critical stage of its history.



Khawaja Nazimuddin

After the creation of Pakistan on 14 August 1947, Khawaja Nazimuddin was appointed the first Chief Minister of East Bengal. After the death of Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah on 11 September 1948, he became the second Governor-General of Pakistan. According to Quaid-e-Azam's constitutional vision, real executive powers rested with the Prime Minister. Following the assassination of Prime Minister Liaquat Ali Khan on 16 October 1951, Khawaja Nazimuddin was appointed the second Prime Minister of Pakistan.



Ghulam Mohammed



Ghulam Muhammad was the **third Governor-General of Pakistan**, serving from **1951 to 1955**. He became Governor-General after the resignation of Khawaja Nazimuddin and played a **dominant role in Pakistan's early political history**. Known for his **assertive and controversial style**, he dismissed Prime Minister **Khawaja Nazimuddin** in 1953 and later removed **Mohammad Ali Bogra** from office, effectively **increasing the powers of the Governor-General** over elected governments. His tenure was marked by **political instability and frequent changes of cabinets**, which weakened parliamentary democracy in Pakistan. Ghulam Muhammad's actions created tensions between the executive and legislature, setting a precedent for **centralized authority and interference in politics**. He resigned in 1955 due to ill health and was succeeded by **Iskander Mirza**.

Muhammad Ali Bogra



Muhammad Ali Bogra served as the **Prime Minister of Pakistan from 1953 to 1955**. He is best known for introducing the “**Bogra Formula**”, which was a proposal to resolve political differences between **East and West Pakistan** by ensuring fair representation in the National Assembly. His tenure focused on **strengthening Pakistan’s foreign relations**, especially with the **United States and Muslim countries**, and promoting economic development. However, his government faced **political instability** due to conflicts with Governor-General **Ghulam Muhammad**, who dismissed cabinets at will. Bogra resigned in 1955, paving the way for the **One Unit policy** and further centralization of power.

Choudhry Muhammad Ali



Chaudhry Muhammad Ali served as the **Prime Minister of Pakistan from 1955 to 1956**. He is most remembered for **drafting and introducing the first Constitution of Pakistan in 1956**, which declared Pakistan an **Islamic Republic** and replaced the Governor-General system with a parliamentary system.

His tenure focused on **administrative reforms, economic planning, and stabilizing government institutions**. However, his government faced **political opposition and conflicts with provincial leaders**, which weakened his position. Chaudhry Muhammad Ali resigned in 1956, but his contribution to **establishing Pakistan's first constitution** remains historically significant.

Iskander Mirza

Iskander Mirza was the **last Governor-General of Pakistan (1955–1956)** and the **first President of Pakistan (1956–1958)**. He played a key role in the **adoption of Pakistan's first Constitution in 1956**, which established the country as an **Islamic Republic** and replaced the Governor-General with a President.

His tenure was marked by **political instability and frequent conflicts with provincial and federal leaders**. In **October 1958**, he declared **martial law**, appointing General Ayub Khan as Chief Martial Law Administrator, which led to the **end of his presidency** and the beginning of military rule. He was later **exiled to London**, where he died in 1969.



West Pakistan



And East Pakistan combine Even after eight years of existence, Pakistan was without a constitution. The main reason was believed to be the fact that there were two unequal wings of Pakistan separated from west Pakistan.

After assuming charge as **Prime Minister, Chaudhry Muhammad Ali** along with his team worked day and night to composed a constitution for Pakistan. His efforts led to **the first constitution made in 1956.**

Hussain Shaheed Suhrawardy

Hussain Shaheed Suhrawardy was a prominent political leader from Bengal who served as the **Prime Minister of Pakistan from 1956 to 1957**. He was known for his **strong advocacy of provincial autonomy**, especially for **East Pakistan**, and played a key role in addressing the **political and economic disparities between East and West Pakistan**.

Suhrawardy focused on **administrative reforms and improving East Pakistan's infrastructure and economy**, but his tenure faced **political instability and opposition from West Pakistani leaders**. He resigned in 1957 amid growing political tensions, leaving a legacy as a **champion of East Pakistan's rights and parliamentary governance**.



Ibrahim Ismail chundrigar

- **Ibrahim Ismail Chundrigar** was a senior **politician and lawyer from Sindh** who served as the **Prime Minister of Pakistan for a brief period in 1957**. His tenure lasted only **a few weeks (October–December 1957)**, making it one of the **shortest in Pakistan's history**.
- Chundrigar faced **political instability and lack of parliamentary support**, which prevented him from implementing significant policies. Despite his short term, he is remembered for his **honest and principled approach** to politics and his efforts to maintain **government continuity during a turbulent period** in Pakistan's early parliamentary history.



Malik Feroz khan



As a 7th Prime minister On December 16, 1957, Malik Feroz Khan took over the office of Prime Minister from Chundrigar. Malik Feroz Khan Noon was the last in the line of Prime Ministers under the president-ship of Iskander mirza.

It was a short story of 1947-1958. With seven prime ministers.

The constitution of 1956

1. Background:

- After independence in **1947**, Pakistan functioned under the **Government of India Act 1935** as an interim constitution. Due to political instability, administrative problems, and disagreements between East and West Pakistan, constitution-making was delayed. Finally, after **9 years**, Pakistan adopted its **first constitution on 23 March 1956**, which came into force the same day.

Main features of 1956 constitution

- **2. Nature of the Constitution**
- The Constitution of 1956 introduced:
- **Republican system** (Pakistan became the *Islamic Republic of Pakistan*)
- **Federal form of government**
- **Parliamentary system**
- **Written constitution**
- The British monarch was replaced by a **President** as Head of State.

- **Islamic Provisions:**

- Islam was given a central position:
- The state was named **“Islamic Republic of Pakistan”**
- No law could be made **against the Quran and Sunnah**
- The President had to be a **Muslim**
- **Islamic Advisory Council** was established to guide legislation
- Muslims were enabled to live according to Islamic teachings

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- **Parliamentary System:**
 - The constitution adopted a **Parliamentary form of government:**
 - **Prime Minister** was the real head of the government.
 - **President** was the ceremonial Head of State
 - Cabinet was collectively responsible to the **National Assembly**
 - Prime Minister was elected by the National Assembly

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- **Legislature (Parliament):**
 - The Parliament was **unicameral**:
 - **National Assembly:**
 - Total members: **300**
 - 150 from East Pakistan
 - 150 from West Pakistan*(Parity principle to satisfy East Pakistan)*
 - Members were elected indirectly.

- **Fundamental Rights**

- The constitution guaranteed **basic rights**, including:
- Equality before law
- Freedom of speech, religion, and association
- Protection of life and property
- Right to profession and movement
- These rights could be suspended during **emergency**.
- **Language and National Identity**
- **Urdu and Bengali** were declared **national languages**
- This was an attempt to reduce tensions between East and West Pakistan.

- **Demerits / Weaknesses:**

- Over-centralization of power
- Parity formula ignored population majority of East Pakistan
- Indirect elections weakened democracy
- Political instability and frequent government changes
- President still had significant discretionary powers
- **Abrogation:**
 - The Constitution of 1956 remained in force for **only 2 years**. It was **abrogated on 7 October 1958** when **president iskander mirza imposed Martial Law**, and appointed **General Ayub khan as CMLA** ending Pakistan's first constitutional experiment.

Military Interventions

The Ayub Khan Era: 1958-1969



General Muhammad Ayub Khan (14 May 1907 – 19 April 1974) was the first Commander-in-Chief of the Pakistan Army (1951–1958) and later became Pakistan's first military ruler. After President Iskander Mirza imposed Martial Law on 7 October 1958, Ayub Khan removed him on 27 October 1958 and assumed the offices of President and Chief Martial Law Administrator. He justified military rule by citing chronic political instability, weak parliamentary institutions, and frequent changes of government during the early years of Pakistan.

- **Political System under Ayub Khan:**

- Ayub Khan introduced a **controlled political system** aimed at stability rather than mass democracy.
- **Major Political Measures:**
- **Martial Law (1958–1962)**
- **Constitution of 1962**
 - Presidential system
 - Strong executive
 - Weak legislature
- **Basic Democracies System (1959)**
 - 80,000 Basic Democrats
 - Electoral college for President and Assemblies

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- **Golden Era of Economic Development (1960–1965)**
 - The period **1960–1965** is widely described by economists and historians as Pakistan's **Golden Era of economic growth**, mainly due to **planned development and political stability**.
 - **Economic Achievements:**
 - **Average GDP growth: 6–7% per annum**
 - Pakistan ranked among the **fastest-growing developing economies**
 - Implementation of **Second Five-Year Plan (1960–65)** — regarded as the most successful plan.
 - Expansion of **industrial and manufacturing sectors**
 - Rapid growth of **private enterprise** under state patronage

These facts are confirmed by Pakistan Economic Surveys, Planning Commission reports, and World Bank assessments.

- **Industrial Development:**

- Ayub Khan strongly promoted **industrialization** as the engine of growth.

- **Key Features:**

- Growth of **textile, cement, sugar, fertilizer, and engineering industries**
- Establishment of **industrial estates** in Karachi, Lahore, and other cities
- Protection and incentives for private investors
- Expansion of banking and credit facilities

- **Criticism:**

Economic power became concentrated in a few hands, famously described by **Dr. Mahbub ul Haq** as the dominance of “**22 industrial families.**”

- **Agricultural Reforms and Green Revolution:**

- Agriculture also witnessed significant growth during Ayub Khan’s era.

- **Reforms:**

- Introduction of **high-yield variety (HYV) seeds**
- Increased use of **fertilizers and pesticides**
- Expansion of **tube-well irrigation**
- Mechanization of farming

- **Results:**

- Increased production of **wheat and rice**

- **Infrastructure and Mega Projects:**

- Ayub Khan's government invested heavily in **infrastructure development**.
- **Major Projects:**
- **Indus Basin Works Agreement (1960)** with India
- Construction of **Mangla Dam**
- Expansion of **roads, highways, and ports**
- Development of communication and energy sectors
- These projects strengthened Pakistan's **economic and strategic capacity**.

- **Foreign Policy and External Support:**

- Ayub Khan pursued a **pro-Western foreign policy**, especially during the Cold War.
- **Highlights:**
- Close alliance with the **United States**
- Membership of **SEATO and CENTO**
- Substantial foreign aid and technical assistance
- Improved relations with **China**
- Foreign aid played a **supportive but not exclusive role** in economic growth.

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- **War of 1965 and Decline:**
 - The **Indo-Pakistan War of 1965** proved to be a **turning point**.
 - **Consequences:**
 - Economic slowdown
 - **Tashkent Declaration (1966)** caused public dissatisfaction.
 - Political opposition intensified.
 - Student and labor movements emerged.
 - Ayub Khan resigned on **25 March 1969**, handing over power to **General Yahya Khan**.

The constitution of 1962

- **Background:**
- After the **abrogation of the Constitution of 1956** and imposition of **Martial Law in October 1958**, General **Muhammad Ayub Khan** aimed to replace parliamentary instability with a strong and stable political system. For this purpose, a new constitution was introduced and **enforced on 8 June 1962**, ending Martial Law formally.
- **2. Nature of the Constitution**
- The Constitution of 1962 was:
- **Written**
- **Rigid**
- **Presidential in character**
- **Highly centralized**
- Initially, the word “**Islamic**” was omitted from the state name, and Pakistan was called the **Republic of Pakistan**. Due to public pressure, the name “**Islamic Republic of Pakistan**” was restored through the **First Constitutional Amendment (1963)**.

- **Presidential System:**

- The Constitution introduced a **strong Presidential system**, replacing parliamentary democracy.
- **President:**
 - Head of State **and** Head of Government
 - Elected indirectly by **Basic Democrats**
 - Term: **5 years**
 - Appointed:
 - Cabinet
 - Governors
 - Judges
 - Could dissolve the National Assembly
 - Held extensive executive powers
 - The President dominated all three branches of government.

- **Basic Democracies System:**

- A unique feature of the 1962 Constitution was the continuation of the **Basic Democracies System (1959)**.
- **80,000 Basic Democrats** (later increased to 120,000)
- Served as: Electoral college for the President, Electoral body for National and Provincial Assemblies Justified as “grassroots democracy”
Most scholars agree it was a **controlled and indirect democracy**, limiting popular participation.

- **Legislature:**

- The Constitution initially provided for a **unicameral legislature**.
- **National Assembly:**
- Members elected indirectly
- Limited powers
- President could:
 - Veto legislation
 - Promulgate ordinances
 - Dissolve the Assembly
- The legislature was **subordinate to the executive**.

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- **Islamic Provisions – Constitution of 1962:**
 - **Islamic features were limited** compared to the 1956 Constitution.
 - Islam was **not central** to the state structure initially.
 - **No law repugnant to Islam** (added after the **1963 First Amendment**).
 - Ensured that legislation conformed with Islamic injunctions.
 - **Advisory bodies on Islamic matters** were created.
 - The **Islamic Advisory Council** guided legislation, but its role was **only advisory**.
 - **President not necessarily required to be Muslim.**
 - Constitution allowed any citizen to become President; politically, it was assumed to be Muslim.
 - **Islam given a secondary constitutional role.**
 - Scholars agree that the 1962 Constitution **prioritized presidential authority and administrative efficiency** over Islamic principles.

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- **Abrogation:**
 - The Constitution of 1962 remained in force until:
 - **25 March 1969, when General Yahya Khan imposed Martial Law**
 - Constitution was **abrogated**
 - National and Provincial Assemblies were dissolved.

General Yahya Khan



General Agha Muhammad Yahya Khan:

Introduction:

- **Full Name:** Agha Muhammad Yahya Khan
- **Born:** 4 February 1917
- **Died:** 10 August 1980
- **Position:** 3rd Military Ruler of Pakistan
- **Tenure:** 25 March 1969 – 20 December 1971

Yahya Khan took power after Ayub Khan's resignation during political unrest.

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- **Rise to Power:**
 - Ayub Khan faced **mass protests and political instability** in 1968–69.
 - On **25 March 1969**, Ayub Khan resigned.
 - As **Army Chief**, Yahya Khan assumed **Presidency and Martial Law**.
 - **Key Point:** Imposed **Nationwide Martial Law**.

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- **Major Political Actions:**
 - **Suspension of 1962 Constitution**
 - Martial law replaced constitutional governance.
 - **Legal Framework Order (LFO) 1970**
 - Laid down rules for Pakistan's **first general elections**.
 - Promised **peaceful transfer of power** to elected representatives.

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- **First General Elections (1970):**
 - Pakistan's **first free and fair nationwide elections.**
 - **Results:**
 - **Awami League (East Pakistan)** – Majority (160 of 162 seats in East)
 - **PPP (West Pakistan)** – Majority in West Pakistan
 - **Issue:** West Pakistani leaders (PPP) resisted giving power to East Pakistan's Awami League → Political deadlock.

- **1971 East Pakistan Crisis:**

- East Pakistan demanded **autonomy** under Awami League's Six-Point Plan.
- Military operation ("Operation Searchlight") **launched by Yahya Khan** in March 1971.
- Widespread **civil unrest and human rights violations** occurred.
- India intervened in **December 1971**, supporting East Pakistan.
- **Result:**
 - Resigned on **20 December 1971** after national humiliation.
 - Transferred power to **Zulfikar Ali Bhutto**.

END OF THE RULE:

- **East Pakistan became Bangladesh** (16 December 1971)
- Pakistan suffered a **military defeat**.

Democratic Transitions

Introduction

Full Name: Zulfikar Ali Bhutto

Born: 5 January 1928, Larkana, Sindh

Died: 4 April 1979, Rawalpindi

Positions:

President of Pakistan: 1971–1973

Prime Minister of Pakistan: 1973–1977

Political Party: Pakistan People's Party (PPP) –
Founder

Bhutto is considered a **charismatic leader** who shaped Pakistan's politics after 1971.



The Zulfikar ali Bhutto Government 1971-1977

- **Rise to Power:**
- After **1971 war & Yahya Khan's resignation**, Bhutto became **President on 20 December 1971**.
- Faced the challenge of **rebuilding Pakistan** after the loss of East Pakistan (Bangladesh).
- Later became **Prime Minister** after **1973 Constitution** was implemented.

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- **Major Achievements:**
 - **Political & Constitutional**
 - **12 August 1973: 1973 Constitution** adopted → Established parliamentary system
 - **14 August 1973:** Becomes **Prime Minister** of Pakistan under new constitution
 - **Economic & Social Reforms:**
 - **1972–1974: Nationalization of banks and industries**
 - **1972–1977:** Land reforms introduced to reduce feudal power
 - Promoted education and social development programs

- **Foreign Policy:**

- Strengthened relations with **China, Middle East, and Muslim countries.**
- Initiated **Pakistan's nuclear program** in early 1970s.

- **Controversies & Challenges:**

- **Authoritarian tendencies** → Press restrictions & political repression
- **Conflict with opposition** (Nawaz Sharif, Wali Khan, etc.)
- Criticism over **economic policies** → Industrial slowdown
- **Military coup of 1977** by General Zia-ul-Haq ended his rule

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- **End of Rule:**
 - **5 July 1977:** Overthrown in a military coup led by **General Zia-ul-Haq**
 - Arrested and tried for political murder.
 - **4 April 1979:** Executed after controversial trial.

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- The Constitution of Pakistan, also known as the 1973 Constitution, is the supreme law of Pakistan. Drafted by the government of Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, with additional assistance from the country's opposition parties, it was approved by the Parliament on 10 April and approved on 14 August 1973.
 - The 1973 Constitution provides for a parliamentary form of government where the executive authority of the state vests with the Prime Minister. The President, according to the Constitution, is at the top, representing the unity of the Republic. From 1947 to 1973, the country had a unicameral(one house system) system of legislature.

CONSTITUTION OF 1973

- A bill to provide a constitution for the **Islamic Republic of Pakistan** was introduced in the assembly on February 2, 1973, which was passed on 12 April, and announced on 14 August, 1973.
- The **salient features of 1973 Constitution of Pakistan** are as under:
- **The Constitution of 1973 is a written document. There are 280 articles and 7 schedules of the Constitution.**

CONSTITUTION OF 1973

- Federal Constitution:
- The Constitution of 1973 is Federal Constitution. It establishes a central government and the governments of the federating units, namely, the province of Punjab, Sindh, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, and Baluchistan.
- Parliamentary form of Government:
- Like the Constitution of 1956 but unlike the Constitution of 1962, the Constitution of 1973, provides Pakistan with a parliamentary form of government.
- In a parliamentary form of government, maximum powers are vested in the elected parliament and the Prime Minister, being head of government has many more powers than the head of State (President).
- Bicameral Legislature:
- The Constitution of 1973 provides for the establishment of a bicameral legislature in Pakistan. Pakistani Parliament consists of two houses, namely, National Assembly, the lower house, and the Senate, the upper house.

CONSTITUTION OF 1973

- Rigid Constitution:
- The Constitution of 1973 is a rigid constitution in the sense that it requires a Two-third majority of the parliament (National Assembly and Senate) for amendment in it.
- Fundamental Rights:
- The 1973 Constitution guarantees fundamental rights to the citizens of Pakistan. Some of these areas are:
 - Equality of all citizens before the law.
 - Security of persons and of their properties and other belongings.
 - Right to acquire, hold or dispose of the property in any part of Pakistan.
 - Freedom of speech
 - Freedom of expression
 - Freedom of association
 - Religious Freedom
 - Right to adopt any lawful profession.

CONSTITUTION OF 1973

- National language:
- The Constitution of 1973 provides for Urdu as the national language of Pakistan. Regional languages have also been provided full protection by the Constitution.

- Islamic Provisions of the Constitution of 1973:

The following are the Islamic provisions of the Constitution of 1973.

- The Constitution of 1973 also names the country the Islamic Republic of Pakistan.
- Islam is the State Religion of Pakistan.
- Sovereignty belongs to Allah Almighty.
- Only Muslims could become the President and Prime Minister of Pakistan.
- Islamic way of life.
- Islamization of laws.

CONSTITUTION OF 1973

- Direct Election System:
- The direct Election System is another salient feature of 1973 Constitution of Pakistan. The members of the National Assembly and Provincial Assembly are selected through Direct Election.
- Conclusions:
- It is concluded that The National Assembly approved the 1973 Constitution of Pakistan on April 10, 1973, and show it on August 14, 1973. Some ***salient features of 1973 Constitution of Pakistan*** are – written, federal, parliamentary, bicameral, rigid, etc.

CURRENT Foreign Policy OF PAKISAN

- **1 – Goals & Priorities of Pakistan's Foreign Policy (2026)**
- **Main Goals:**
 - Maintain **peaceful, balanced relations** with all countries
 - Respect **sovereignty and non-interference**
 - Promote **regional stability and dialogue**
- **Regional & Strategic Focus:**
 - **China:** Strong strategic & economic partner; One-China policy supported
 - **United States:** Relations improving; cooperation based on mutual interests
 - **Saudi Arabia & GCC:** Defence and security cooperation; Strategic Defence Pact signed in 2025
- **Foreign Policy Priorities:**
 - **Regional peace:** Dialogue and conflict resolution (e.g., Kashmir, Afghanistan)
 - **Economic diplomacy:** Attract foreign investment (FDI), trade promotion
 - **Counter-terrorism:** Cooperation to fight extremism and maintain security

• 2 – Key Bilateral Relations & Challenges:

- **Bilateral Relations:**

- **China:** Strategic partnership, defence, trade, diplomacy
- **United States:** Cooperation on security, diplomacy, economy
- **Saudi Arabia:** Military and strategic cooperation, Gulf security
- **India:** Tense; peace dialogue limited; regional stability remains challenging
- **Challenges:**
 - Economic constraints affect foreign policy autonomy
 - Balancing relations between major powers is complex
 - Regional tensions (especially with India) limit diplomatic progress

Summary:

“Pakistan’s current foreign policy seeks balanced and peaceful relations, strengthens strategic partnerships with China, the US, and Saudi Arabia, promotes economic diplomacy, and engages multilaterally to maintain regional stability.”

The Zia Regime: 1977-1988

Mohammad *Zia-ul-Haq* was born Aug. 12, 1924, Jullundur, Punjab and died in Aug. 17, 1988, near Bahawalpur, Pakistan.

- **Event leading to Bhutto's hanging**
- ISLAMABAD, Pakistan, Wednesday, April 4 Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, the former Prime Minister of Pakistan, was hanged early today in the Rawalpindi District Jail, where he had been confined since his position last year on- charges of murder a political opponent(enemy) in 1974.

Event leading to Bhutto's hanging

- A senior spokesman for the military Government said the execution had taken place at 4 A.M. The spokesman, Wing Commander Mohammed Afzal, stated that the body had been taken immediately to Mr. Bhutto's birthplace near Larkana In Sindh Province and buried in ceremony attended by family members.
- Jail sources said that the hanging had taken place in the **presence** of officials of the military Government, which headed by **President Mohammed Zia ul Haq**.

Major policies and the process of Islamization

- When General Zia-ul-Haq took over as the Chief Martial Law Administrator on July 5, 1977, Islamization was given a new boost. General Zia-ul-Haq was a practicing Muslim who raised the slogan of Islam. The Islamic sentiment has always been fully alive in Pakistan. Various governments have used this to their benefit. There are people who doubt Zia's reasons for raising the Islamic slogan; whether it was for political purposes to counter balance Bhutto's appeal or was it to enforce Islam in its true sense.

Major policies and the process of Islamization

- General Zia wanted to bring the legal, social, economic and political institutions of the country in accordance with the Islamic principles, values and traditions in the light of Quran and Sunnah, to enable the people of Pakistan to lead their lives in accordance to Islam. The Government of Zia-ul-Haq took a number of steps to eradicate non-Islamic practices from the country. He introduced the Zakat, Ushr, Islamic Haddood and Penal Code in the country. The Government invited great scholars to compile laws about Islamic financing. The Zakat and Ushr Ordinance to Islamize the economic system was promote on June 20, 1980.

Major policies and the process of Islamization

- Zia-ul-Haq selected his Majlis-i-Shoora in 1980. It was to be the Islamic Parliament and act as the Parliament of Pakistan in place of the National Assembly. A number of other Islamization programs were carried out including the teaching of Islamic Studies and Arabic, which were made compulsory.
- Pakistan Studies and Islamic Studies were made compulsorily for B. A., B. Sc., Engineering, M. B. B. S., Commerce, Law and Nursing students. For professional studies, **extra marks were given** to people who were **Hafiz-e-Quran. General Zia-ul-Haq wanted** to make Pakistan the strong hold of Islam so that it could play an honorable and prominent role for **the Islamic world**.

Foreign Policy focus on Afghanistan

- **Afghanistan** is our Muslim neighbor and any development taking place there will definitely impact us. In December 1979, the Russian aggression in Afghanistan had brought serious implications for our safety security and sovereignty.
- General Ziaul Haq willingly took upon himself to house and feed 35 million Afghan refugees, and provided moral, financial, military and diplomatic support to Afghan freedom fighters. He did all this in such a skillful way that it drew world attention.

Foreign Policy focus on Afghanistan

- World will not forget the role of General Ziaul Haq and his military commanders in Afghanistan's struggling for independence. His role, strategy, politics and vision, skillful military planning and achievement will be remembered for long.
- As a military commander, strategist and humanist. He stood side by side with the Mujahidin against a super power in a faithful manner. He did all this when Pakistan was itself facing financial and political instability and regional threats.

Down fall of Gen- zia ul haq

- After lifting martial law and holding [non-partisan elections](#) in 1985, Zia appointed [Muhammad Khan Junejo](#) Prime Minister but collect more presidential powers via the [Eighth Amendment](#) to the [Constitution](#).
- After Junejo signed the [Geneva Accords](#) in 1988 against Zia's wishes, and called for an inquiry into the [Ojhri Camp disaster](#), Zia dismissed Junejo's government and announced fresh elections in November 1988. He was killed along with several of his top military officials and two American diplomats in a mysterious plane crash near [Bahawalpur](#) on 17 August 1988.

Benazir Bhutto and Nawaz Sharif Government 1988-1999



Benazir Bhutto was born on 21 June 1953 and died on 27 December 2007, she was a Pakistani first woman politician who served as the 11th prime minister of Pakistan from 1988 to 1990.

Benazir Bhutto

1. Historical Background

- Pakistan remained under military rule of General Zia-ul-Haq (1977–1988).
- On 17 August 1988, General Zia-ul-Haq died in a plane crash.
- After his death, general elections were announced.
- The elections marked the end of 11 years of military dictatorship

Benazir Bhutto

2. Elections of 1988

- Elections held in **November 1988**.
- **Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP)** emerged as the largest party.
- PPP formed the government in 1988 with the support of MQM and independent members.
- On **2 December 1988**, Benazir Bhutto took oath as Prime Minister.
- **Historical Significance**
 - **First female Prime Minister of Pakistan**
 - **First woman Prime Minister of any Muslim country**
- This was seen worldwide as a **symbol of democracy and women empowerment**.

Benazir Bhutto

3. Power Structure During First Tenure

- **President:** Ghulam Ishaq Khan
- **Army Chief:** General Mirza Aslam Beg
- **Foreign Policy & Defense** remained largely under: President and Military establishment. Benazir had **limited authority**, especially in security matters.

4. Political Policies & Democratic Measures:

- Restored democracy/**civilian leadership** after years of dictatorship.
- **Allowed:** Political parties to function freely, Trade unions and student unions.

Benazir Bhutto released several political prisoners in 1988, including Khan Abdul Wali Khan, Ghaus Bakhsh Bizenjo, Ataulлах Mengal, and many detained democratic activists of the Zia era.

- **Conclusion:**

Benazir Bhutto's first tenure ended on **6 August 1990** when President **Ghulam Ishaq Khan** dissolved the **National and Provincial Assemblies under Article 58(2)(b)** on charges of **corruption, misgovernance, and poor law and order**. Despite its short duration, the tenure is important for restoring civilian democracy after military rule

Nawaz Sharif



Nawaz Sharif – First Tenure as Prime Minister (1990–1993)

1. Start of First Tenure

- **Became Prime Minister: 6 November 1990**
- **President:** Ghulam Ishaq Khan
- **Political Party:** Pakistan Muslim League (N) – PML(N)
- **How:** Nawaz Sharif came into power after the dismissal of **Benazir Bhutto's first government** by the President under Article 58(2)(b).
- **Significance:** He became the **youngest Prime Minister at that time** and represented a **pro-business, conservative agenda**.

Important Events and Policies

- **Economic Policy & Privatization:**
 - Focused on **privatization of state-owned enterprises**.
 - Encouraged **industrial growth and private sector development**.
 - Introduced **tax reforms** to increase revenue.
- **Nuclear Program:**
 - Strengthened Pakistan's **nuclear program** under the leadership of Dr. Abdul Qadeer Khan.
- **Law and Order / Governance:**
 - Tried to control **Islamabad and Karachi unrest**, but faced political opposition and conflicts with provincial governments.
- **Relationship with President:**
 - Initially had a good working relationship with **President Ghulam Ishaq Khan**, but tensions grew over governance and power-sharing.
- **Foreign Policy:**
 - Maintained **close ties with the United States and Gulf countries**.
 - Supported **peace in Afghanistan** and Pakistan's **regional security interests**.
- **Political Challenges:**
 - Faced opposition from **PPP (Benazir Bhutto)** and internal PML(N) conflicts.
 - Accusations of **corruption and misuse of power** started to emerge.

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- **3. End of First Tenure**

- **Ended: 18 April 1993**
- **Reason:** Conflict with **President Ghulam Ishaq Khan** escalated. Both the President and PM resigned to avoid a constitutional crisis.
- **Significance:** Showed the **fragility of democratic governments in Pakistan** during the early 1990s due to **power struggles between the President and Prime Minister**.

- **4. Importance of First Tenure**

- First tenure was focused on **economic reforms, privatization, and pro-business policies**.
- Marked the **beginning of Nawaz Sharif's political rise**.
- Set a pattern of **political instability and frequent dismissals in Pakistan**

Second era of Benazir Bhutto

- **Benazir Bhutto – Second Tenure as Prime Minister (1993–1996)**
- **1. Start of Second Tenure**
- **Became Prime Minister: 19 October 1993**
- **Political Party:** Pakistan Peoples Party (PPP)
- **President:** Farooq Leghari
- Came to power after the **resignation of Nawaz Sharif and President Ghulam Ishaq Khan** and the **general elections of 1993.**
- This was her **second term as Prime Minister.**

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- **Government Structure – Second Tenure (1993–1996)**
 - **Prime Minister:** Benazir Bhutto
 - Head of the federal government
 - Responsible for executive decisions, policy-making, and administration
 - **President:** Farooq Leghari
 - Ceremonial head, but also had powers under **Article 58(2)(b)**
 - Could dissolve assemblies and dismiss the Prime Minister
 - **Federal Cabinet / Ministers:**
 - Chosen by the Prime Minister
 - Responsible for different ministries such as:
 - Finance
 - Foreign Affairs
 - Health and Education, etc.
 -

- **Coalition Support:**

- PPP formed government with **MQM and independent members**
- Coalition members held key provincial or federal positions

- **Provincial Governments:**

- Provincial Chief Ministers were usually from **PPP** in Punjab, Sindh, Baluchistan, and NWFP (now Khyber Pakhtunkhwa)
- They reported to the federal government but had autonomy in provincial matters

- **Key Features:**

- Parliamentary system under **1973 Constitution**
- Power shared between **Prime Minister (executive)** and **President (constitutional powers)**
- Strong influence of coalition partners in decision-making

Second era of Benazir Bhutto

- **Policies and Economic Policies**
- **1. General Policies**
- Focused on **social welfare and human development**.
- Launched the **Lady Health Workers Programme** to provide basic health services to women and children.
- Promoted **women empowerment** and female participation in public life.
- Emphasized **human rights and democratic freedoms**.
- Tried to strengthen **civilian institutions**, but political instability limited success.

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- **Economic Policies**
 - Continued **privatization of state-owned enterprises.**
 - Encouraged **private sector investment and industrial growth.**
 - Faced serious economic problems:
 - Inflation
 - Rising foreign debt
 - Budget deficit
 - Relied on **IMF and World Bank loans** to stabilize the economy.
 - Economic performance remained weak due to **law and order issues and corruption allegations.**

• 4. Foreign Policy

- Improved relations with:
 - **United States**
 - **European countries**
- Continued support for:
 - Kashmir cause
 - Afghan peace process
- Maintained Pakistan's nuclear policy despite international pressure.

• 5. Problems Faced

- Serious allegations of: Corruption and **Nepotism**
- Her husband **Asif Ali Zardari** faced strong criticism.
- Political opposition intensified.
- Breakdown of trust between:
 - Prime Minister and President

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- **6. Dismissal of Government (1996)**
 - **On 5 November 1996, President Farooq Leghari dismissed Benazir Bhutto's government.**
 - **Action taken under Article 58(2)(b).**
 - **Reasons given:**
 - Corruption
 - Misgovernance
 - Poor law and order
 - **National and Provincial Assemblies were dissolved.**

Second time Nawaz Sharif era

- **Second** term as prime minister (1997–1999) .
Atomic policy · Economic policy · Foreign policy ·
Constitutional amendments · Policy on
anti-terrorism · **Nawaz Sharif** as the **Prime Minister** for the second time on February 17 with
a “heavy mandate”. His party-men also managed
to become Chief Ministers of Punjab, Sindh, and
NWFP, and Akhtar Mengal of BNP took charge in
Balochistan. Nawaz Sharif was lucky that Senate
elections were scheduled only a month after he
came to power.

Second time Nawaz Sharif era

- He nominated his younger brother, **Shahbaz Sharif**, as the **Chief Minister** of the biggest and the most powerful province, Punjab. Furthermore, though after passing of the thirteenth amendment, he had no threat from the President, yet, in December, he got rid of Leghari and managed to bring in his party loyalist, Muhammad Rafiq Tarar as his replacement.
- He not only developed differences with the Chief Justice, Sajjad Ali Shah, and Army Chief, Gen. Jahangir Karamat but also forced both of them to quit.
- He wanted to gain absolute power, and for that purpose, his party tabled the fifteenth amendment bill in the parliament, commonly known as Shariat Bill, on August 28, 1998, the purpose of which was to become all-powerful ***Amir-ul-Momineen***.

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- But the event which made him a hero of the emotional nation was when on May 28, 1998, he, in retaliation of **India's nuclear** tests and disregard of the threat of sanctions from the United States, ordered Pakistan to go nuclear. Problems started for him when he developed differences with **Gen. Pervaiz Musharraf**, whom he had appointed as the Army Chief by superseding two senior Generals.
 - Musharraf was not happy with Nawaz Sharif's initiative of "Bus Diplomacy" with India and when Atal Behari Vajpayee came to Pakistan in February 1999, he clearly showed his distrust by not welcoming him at the Wagah border. Kargil's conflict with India further widened the gulf between the two senior Generals.

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- Eventually, on October 12, Nawaz Sharif dismissed Musharraf when he was out of the country. Senior Army officers did not accept Nawaz Sharif's decision and as a result of military coup, they arrested the Prime Minister and took over the command of the country.
 - Musharraf, on his return, assumed the charge, declared him Chief Executive, inducted a non-elected civilian cabinet, and decided not to call it a Martial Law. Constitution was suspended and Provisional Constitutional Order was enforced. Six judges of the Supreme Court refused to take oath under PCO, whoever the remaining judges validated the coup and gave Musharraf three years to fix the system before transferring power to the elected representatives of the people.

Musharraf's Rule: 1999-2008



General Pervez Musharraf was born in August 11th 1943, and died in February 12th 2023. After months of contentious relations between Sharif and Musharraf, Sharif unsuccessfully attempted to remove Musharraf as the army's leader. In retaliation, the army staged a **coup d'état in 1999**, which allowed Musharraf to take over Pakistan as a **tenth president of pakistan** in 2001.

Musharraf's Rule: 1999-2008

- **GEN.PARVEZ MUSHARRAF's works.**
- **Referendum 2002.** The referendum took place on April 30, 2002, with no competition and no option but to vote for General Musharraf.
- **General Elections 2002.** After three years of military rule, Pakistan again headed towards democracy on October 10, 2002.
- **Prime Minister [2002] Zafarullah Khan Jamali.** was elected the 19th Prime Minister of Pakistan by the newly elected Parliament on November 21, 2002

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- **Prime Minister [2004] Shaukat Aziz.** Becomes Prime Minister [2004]
 - **2005 an earthquake.** October 2005 an earthquake in Pakistan killed over 100,000 people in the country's North
 - **Lal Masjid Operation.** The operation held in July 2007 • Operation was between Islamic fundamentalist militants and government.
 - **Major Achievements.** of Musharraf 6. Major Industrial estates were being developed under Musharraf's vision: M3 industrial, Sundar industrial estate, Chakri industrial,

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- Nine world class engineering universities were developed. The cost of building these Universities was over Rs 96.5 billion. 2. In 1999-2000 there were 31 Public Universities.
 - In 2005-2006 there were 49 Public Universities. Air University (established 2002); Institute of Space Technology, IST (established 2002); University of Science & Technology, Bannu (established 2005); University of Hazara (founded 2002); University of Gujrat (established 2004); Virtual University of Pakistan,
 - **Death of Benazir.** Economy effects on Pakistan: Following a three-day shut-down,
 - **2008 Elections.** On 06 September 2008 **Asif Ali Zardari** won an estimated 482 of the 702 votes from lawmakers to become what some believe will be Pakistan's most powerful civilian leader.

Asif Ali Zardari Era

- Asif Ali Zardari, was(born on July 26, 1955, Karachi, Pakistan).He was a politician who served as ***president of Pakistan from (2008 to 13)*** . In the parliamentary elections of February 2008, the PPP captured one-third of the available seats, while the party of [Nawaz Sharif](#) won one-fourth of the seats. In March the two parties formed a [coalition government](#). Although disagreements destabilized the administration in the months following its formation

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- In August 2008 Zardari and Sharif led the movement to impeach President. [Pervez Musharraf](#). To avoid further public embarrassment, Musharraf resigned his office. Sharif and Zardari were not [reconciled](#), however, and their sustained fight ultimately caused Sharif to withdraw his party from the coalition. Zardari easily won the September 2008 presidential elections.

Asif Ali Zardari Era

- Zardari continued to play a key role in the PPP in the years after his presidency. He left the country in 2015, however, amid tensions with the security establishment. Shortly after his return in late 2016, he announced his intention to contest the 2018 legislative elections, after which he entered the National Assembly as one of the leaders of the opposition.
- As a growing number of opposition figures were pursued on corruption charges, including [Nawaz Sharif](#), Zardari himself was arrested in June 2019 and released on bail in December.
- He continued to face charges of money laundering, however, and his son, Bilawal, began taking on a greater role in party leadership. Zardari completed their era.

Third time Nawaz Sharif as a Prime Minister

- Sharif began his third term as [prime minister](#) as a popular reformer. The economy improved substantially, with higher growth rates, a stable rupee, and lower inflation.
- The [country's infrastructure](#), however, continued to face hurdles, with demand for [electricity](#) outpacing supply and resulting in frequent and widespread shortages. His [foreign policy](#) agenda was oriented toward liberalizing trade, including with Pakistan's neighbors.
- To do so, he made overtures for peaceful relations with [India](#) and post-NATO [Afghanistan](#) and attempted to reach a peace settlement with the Tehreek-e Taliban Pakistan (TTP), an Islamist insurgency operating in Pakistan and unaffiliated with the Taliban in neighboring Afghanistan

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- Under Sharif, Pakistan saw significant investment from [China](#) as the flagship program of China's "Belt and Road Initiative" (BRI).
 - China lent Pakistan tens of billions of dollars in order to develop Pakistan's infrastructure and build a [China-Pakistan Economic Corridor](#) (CPEC) that would allow China access to cheaper, more efficient trade routes.
 - One of the program's grandest projects was the development of the [Gwadar](#) seaport and a highway connecting it to China's [Xinjiang](#) province. However, with the development projects paid for through hefty loans from China that required employment of Chinese businesses, Pakistan's collapsed.

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- The 2015 leak of [confidential](#) international financial documents known as the [Panama Papers](#) linked three of Sharif's children to offshore companies that they had allegedly used to purchase real estate in London. Sharif and his children denied any wrongdoing, but a corruption probe was opened into the matter.
 - In 2017 the Supreme Court disqualified Sharif from holding public office, forcing his resignation. He was replaced by Shahid Khaqan Abbasi as prime minister. Sharif's brother [Shehbaz Sharif](#) was selected to lead the PML-N party in the next elections.
 - When the elections were held in late July, [Imran Khan's](#) PTI party outperformed the PML-N. To guarantee security in the highly [contentious](#) election, the military had stationed at least 350,000 troops at the polling stations, and the Election Commission had granted the military judicial [power](#) at those polling stations.
 - While Khan praised the elections as the fairest in Pakistan's history, the PML-N and the other parties expressed concern that the military had interfered in the elections, especially after their poll observers were ordered to leave polling stations before votes were counted. Nonetheless, the PML-N conceded, allowing Khan to seek a coalition and become prime minister.

Imran Khan Era

- **Imran Ahmed Khan Niazi** was born 5 October 1952 Imran Khan is a Pakistani politician and former cricket captain who served as a **Prime Minister** of Pakistan from August 2018 until April 2022, when he was ousted through a no-confidence vote in the National Assembly.
- **Highlights of the Key Achievements**
- Loans repaid by PTI govt in 22 months: RS 5000 Billion
- Amount borrowed from State Bank in 22 months: NIL
- Panagahs established by PTI govt in 22 months: 200+
- Rs 2 Billion allocated to transform PM house into a university.
- Effective diplomacy saved Pakistan from paying \$1.2bn penalty in Karkey case

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- **Kartarpur corridor** constructed and made operational within months.
 - **Modi exposed** across the globe, Kashmir issues raised at international forums, India isolated.
 - 10 billion tree Tsunami project praised across the globe and being replicated by other developed countries.
 - **Sehat Saholat card** being provided to every family in KPK. Providing Insurance coverage worth 1 million per family annually.
 - Rs 150 Billion+ distributed among the needy through the **Ehsas Emergency Cash program**. And so many works he had done.

Reasons of down fall of Khan's government

- The PDM was formed in September by the leader of the Jamiat Ulema-e-Islam, Fazal-ur-Rehman, but constituted by 11 political parties, A new unified anti-government movement emerged in Pakistan amid a worsening economic crisis.
- The Pakistan Democratic Movement (PDM), an alliance of 11 opposition parties, was formed in September and held large rallies in three major cities. It planned more protests in the march in Islamabad . At the end the government of Khan breaks down and **Mr. Shahbaz Sharif** took over the charge of the country as a Prime minister of Pakistan.